



2025

Dec 2025





Address

Dian Fossey Gorilla Fund
126 Avenue Tulipier,
Commune Goma
Goma, RDC.

Mobile

+243 997701888

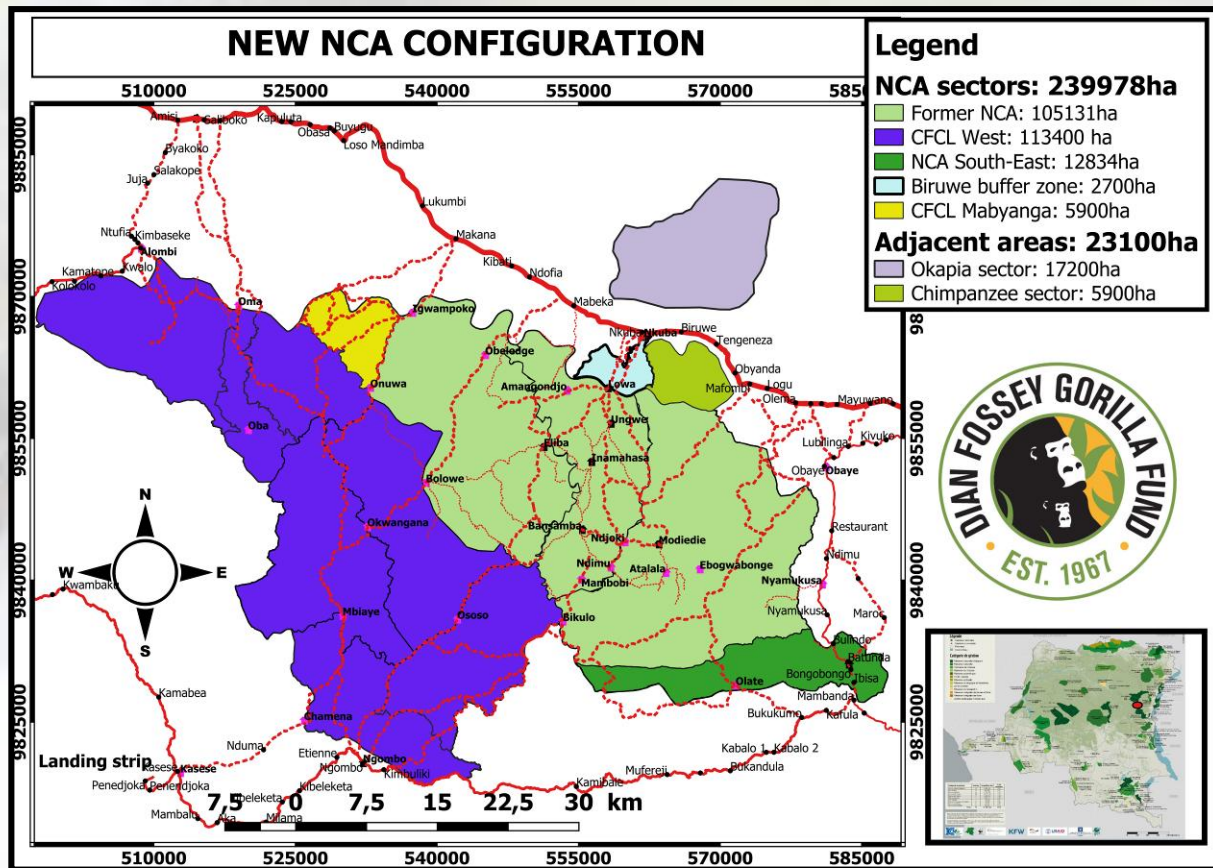
Contact

Urbain NGOBOBO, Country
ungobobo@gorillafund.org

A. GORILLA GROGRAM

The Nkuba Conservation Area (NCA), supported by the Dian Fossey Gorilla Fund, is located in two sister provinces: North Kivu and Maniema, with an estimated total surface area of 2399,78 Sq Km. To the north of the NCA, there is an adjacent area of 231 km² where we are conducting surveys for chimpanzees and okapi.

The operational configuration of the NCA, at the end of December 2025, is as follows:



a. SECTORS COVERAGE

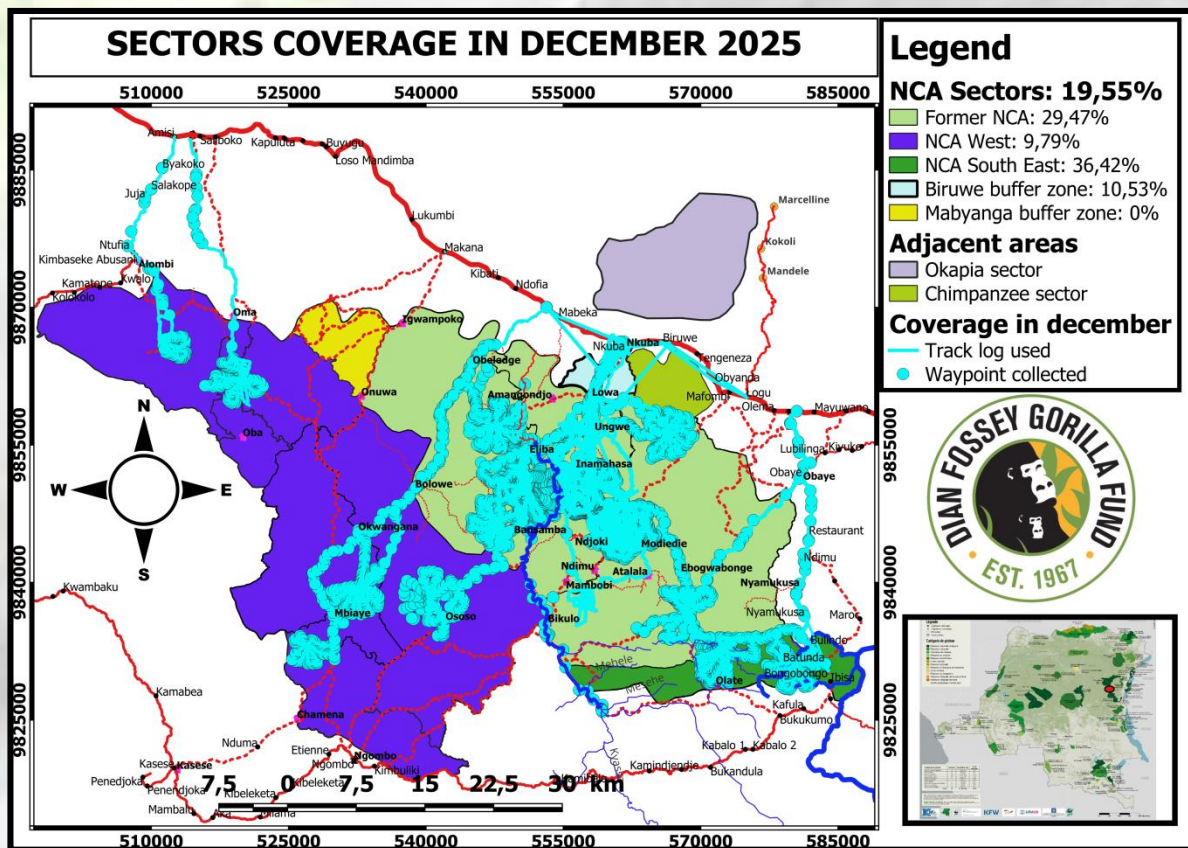
During the month of December 2025, the gorilla program carried out 33 missions out of 39 planned outings, representing an 84.6% completion rate.

Type of assignments

TYPE MISSION	NUMBER	RESPONSIBLE	DETAILS
Tracking	10 out of 10	Team leader	5 Gorilla families
Surveillance	17 out of 16	Team leader	7 NCA-wide surveillance teams
Cheickpoint at the beach	6 out of 6	Team	3 Beach: Mabeka, Nkuba, Mafombi
Construction of payottes	0 out of 7	Program manager	2 payottes on the site

SECTORS COVERAGE RATE : 19.55%

Illustrative image of the sector



COVERAGE BY NCA SECTOR :

The Nkuba Conservation Area administrative map is subdivided into the following 5 sectors:

- 1. NCA/3 CFCLs Sector:** Covers the former part of the NCA made up of 3 CFCLs Mbungu, Seko and Nsuhu with 2 deployment stations located in Nkuba and Obaye;
- 2. Maniema Extension Sector:** This covers all the NCA West located in Maniema province, with Amisi and Ngombo-Kasese as deployment stations;
- 3. North Kivu Extension Sector:** This covers the part of the NCA South-East located in Bongobongo station.
- 4. Bayugu buffer zone:** This is the part of the NCA located at the western corner of CFCL Mbungu, where the Onuwa river meets the Lowa river, and belonging to the Bayugu family. The Bayugu family agrees to this buffer zone being established as the Mabyanga CFCL.
- 5. Biruwe buffer zone:** Biruwe Extension is the area buffer zone of forest belonging to the Abambenga and Sake families located north of the former NCA on either side of the Biruwe River.
- 6. Recently, we have been conducting wildlife surveys in the northern sector of the NCA, where the okapi is believed to live.**

The table below details the coverage of these 5 sectors, calculated from the Excel table drawn based on the georeferenced map subdivided into 2558 grides of 1 Km X 1 Km.

Quadrats NCA de tous les secteurs	
1km X 1km	
TOTAL	2558

Quadrats touchés par secteur	Quadrats partagés + quadrats partagés 50%	Quadrats non partagés	Quadrats partagés comptent comme 50% d'un quadrat
3 CFCLs (Nkuba-Obaye)	1096	1070	26
Extension Maniema	1205	1186	19
Extension Nord-Kivu	151	138	13
Extension Biruwe	38	34	4
Extension Bayugu	68	58	10
TOTAL	2558	2486	72

December 2025	
% de NCA	
Quadrats	500
	19,55%

Total des quadrats couverts	% par secteur
323	29,47%
118	9,79%
55	36,42%
04	10,53%
00	0,00%
500	

Nkuba Conservation Area

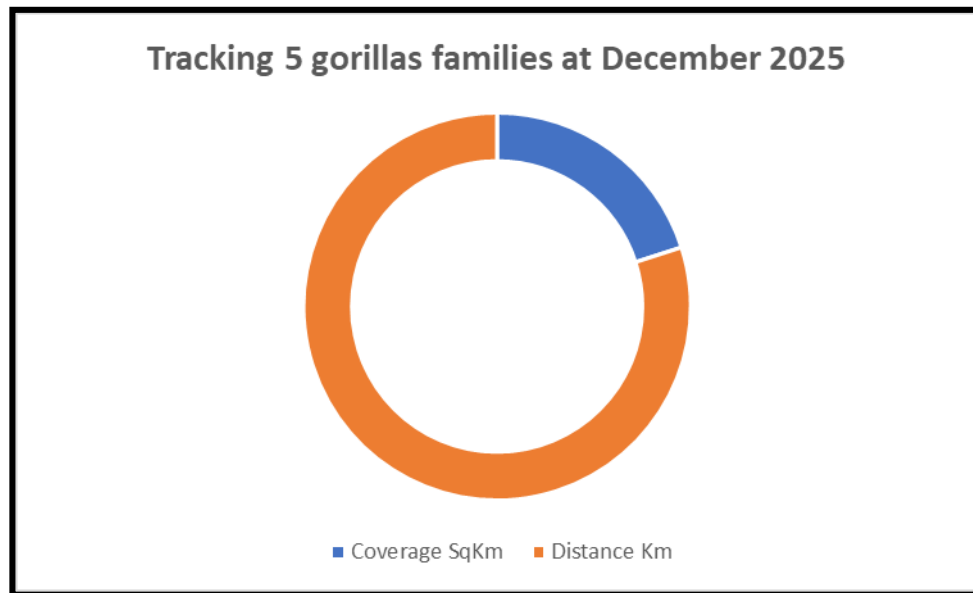
Site web : <https://gorillafund.org/>

Phone :(+243) 973528843 |844452283

Goma-DR Congo

@savinggorillas

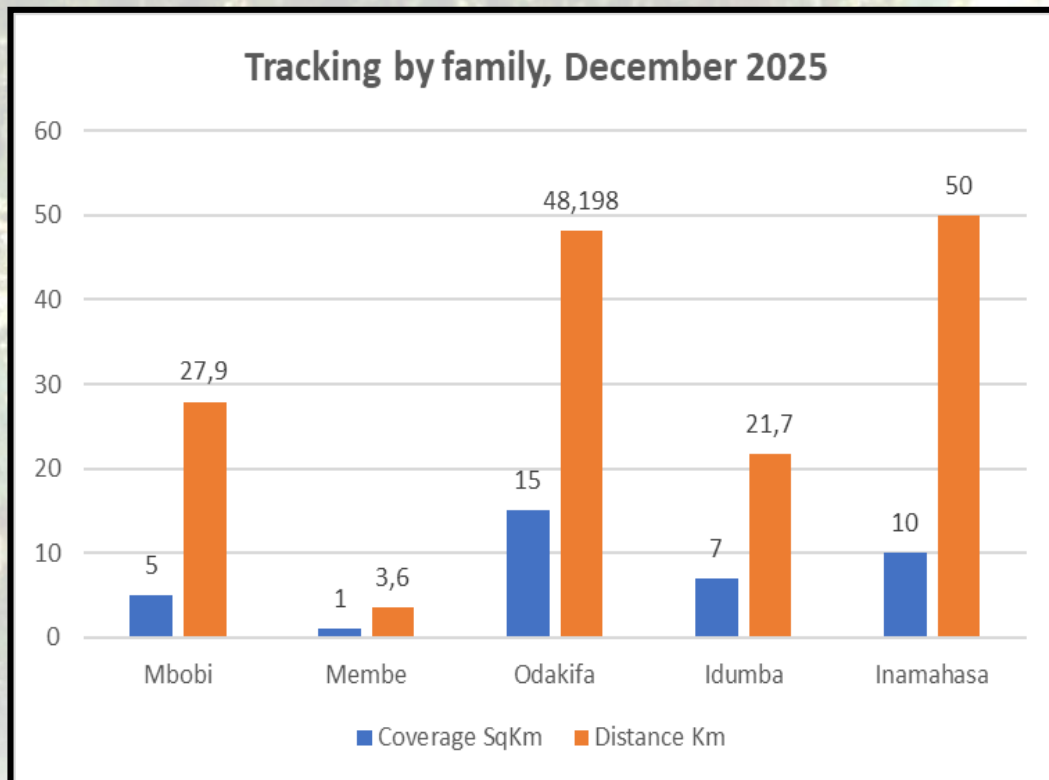
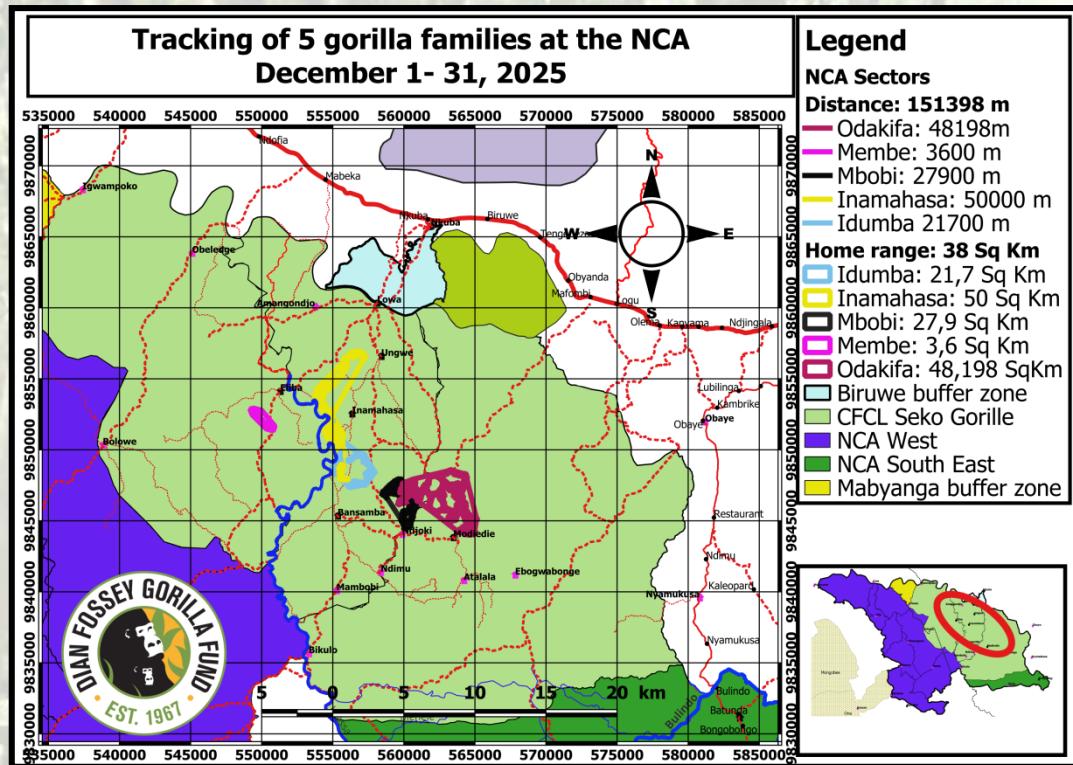
b. GORILLA TRACKING



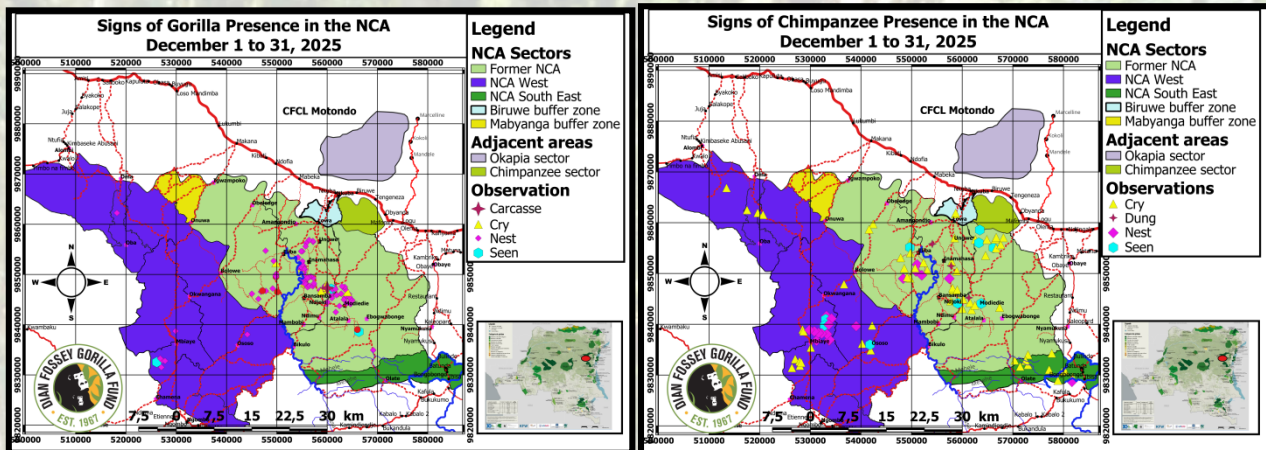
Tracking by sector/Family

<i>Gorilla families</i>	<i>Distance covered</i>	<i>Living space</i>
Membe	3600 m	1 Sq. Km
Mbobi/Bansamba	27900 m	5 Sq. Km
Temps Présent 1/Idumba	21700 m	7 Sq. Km
Temps Présent 2/Inamahasa	50000 m	10 Sq. Km
Odakifa/Modiedie	48198 m	15 Sq. Km
Total	151398 m	38 Sq. Km

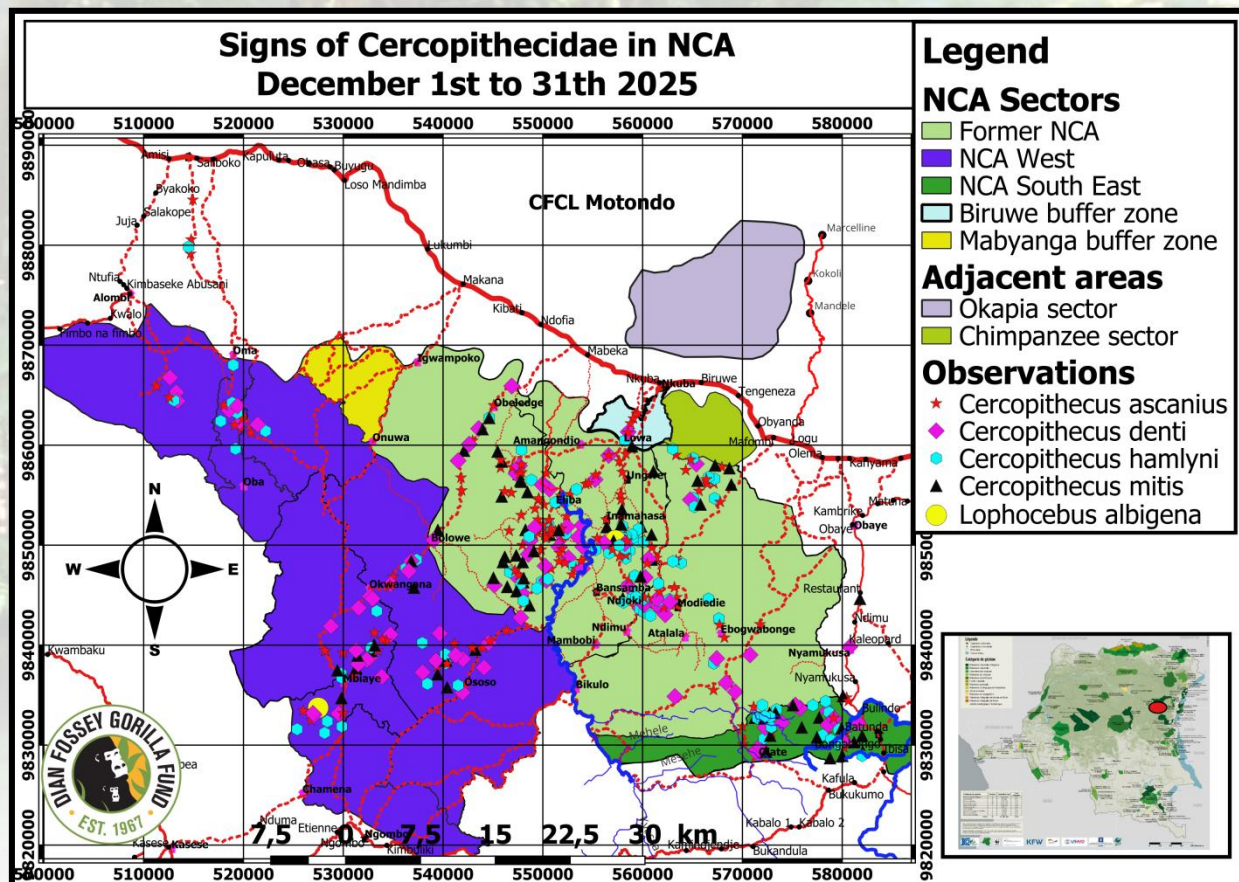
ILLUSTRATIVE MAP and CHART



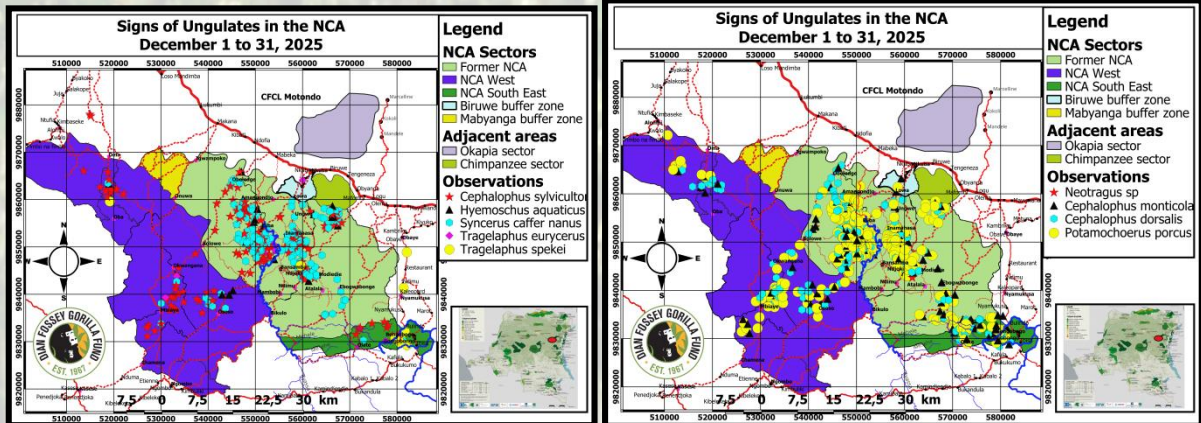
- Method used during surveillance: **We used the Sweep Method with 1Km X 1Km quadras.**
- Sectors concerned: **Amisi, Bongobongo, Ngombo, Nkuba, Obaye and Okwangana.**
- Wild life observation :
 - Great apes : Gorilla et Chimpanzee



- Small monkey : **Cercopithecidae**

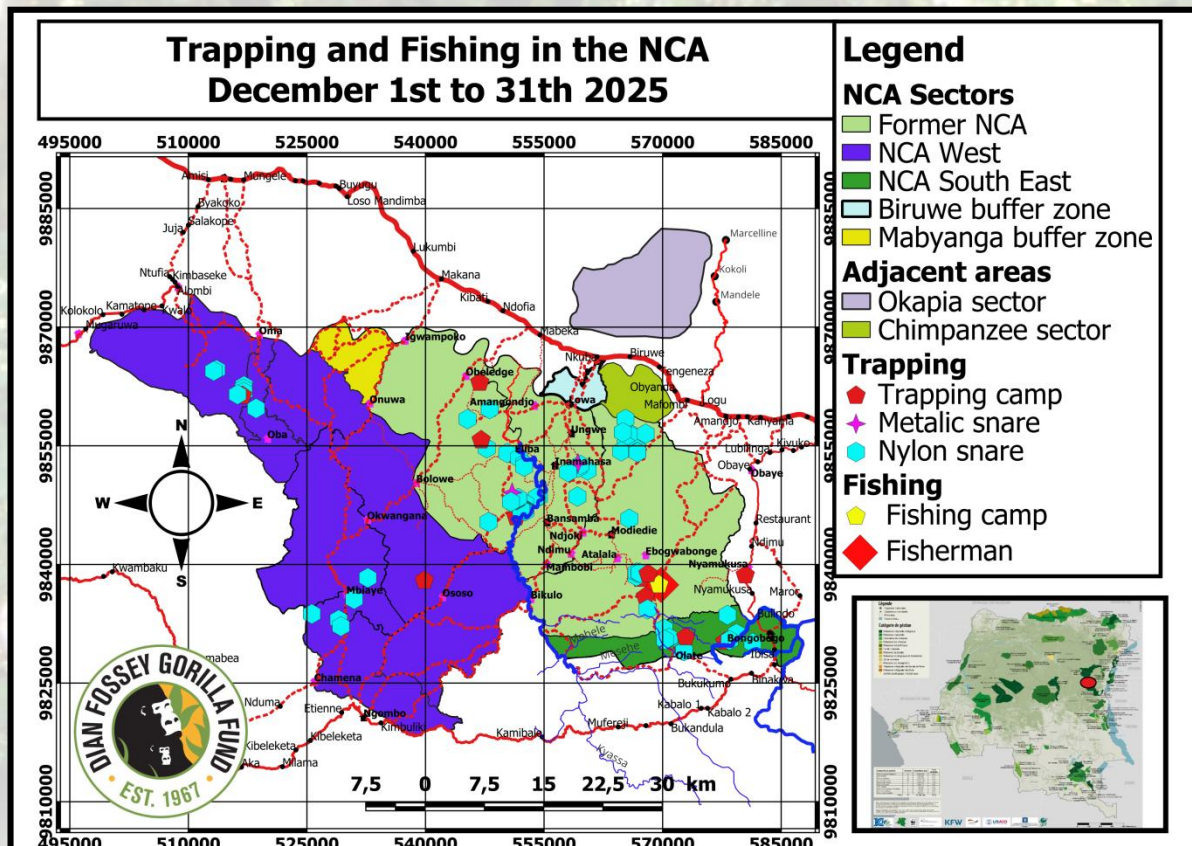


- Ungulates

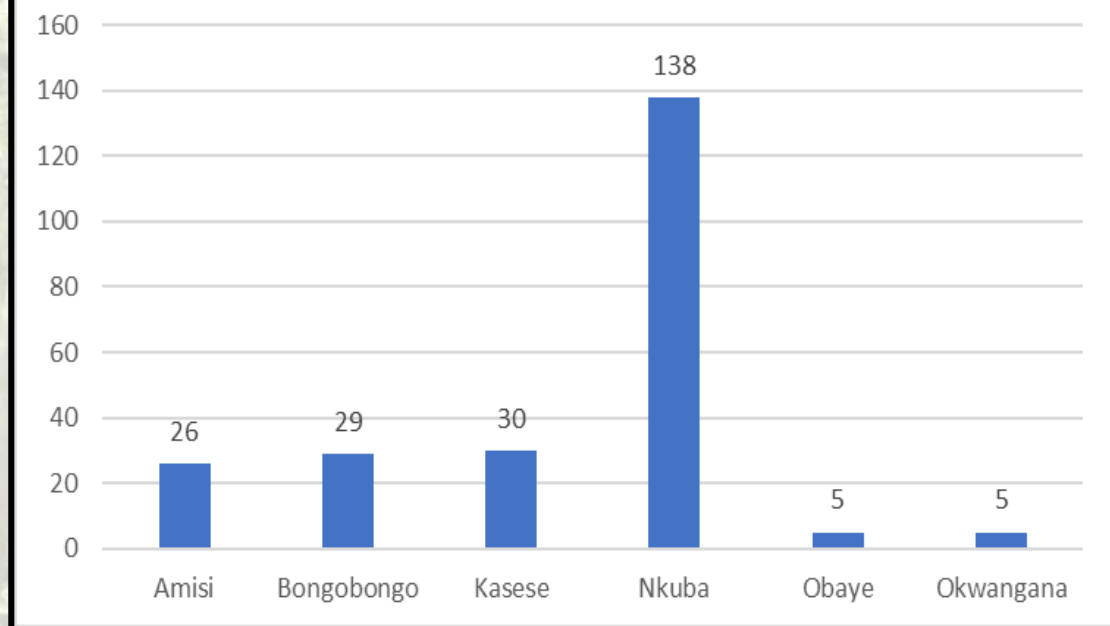


- Anthropogenic activity index :
 - Trapping and fishing,

Trapping and fishing cards :

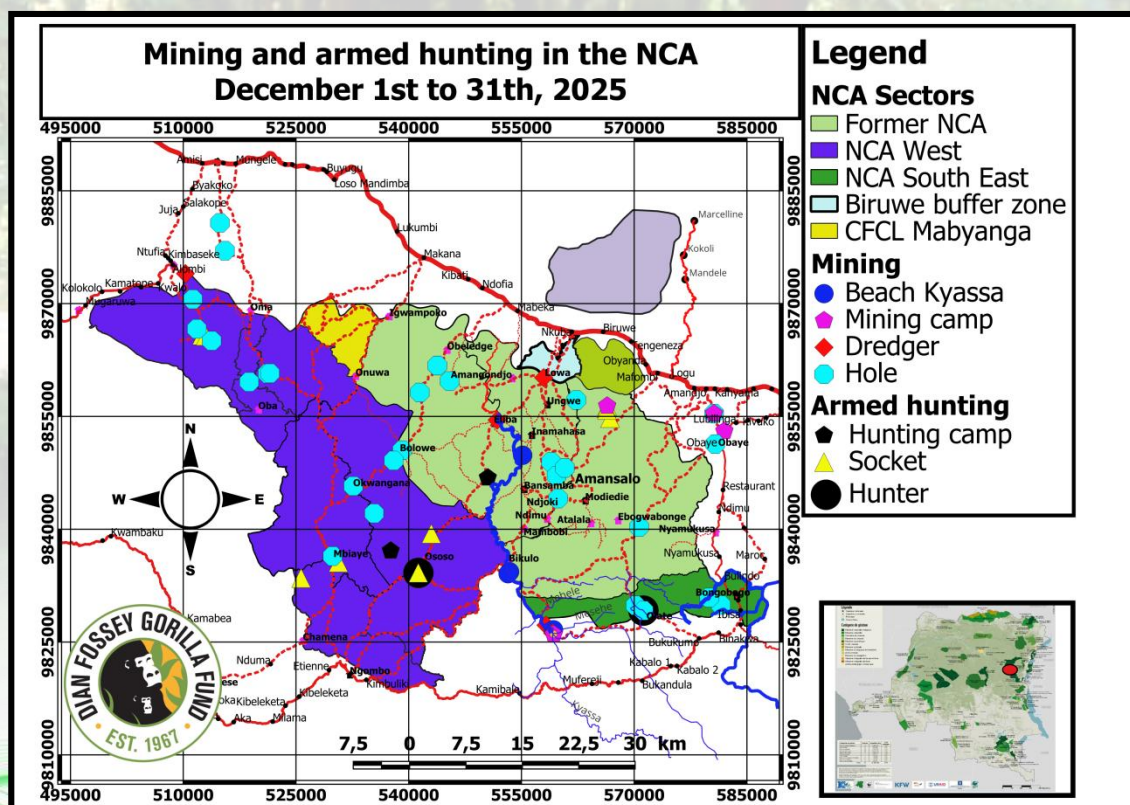


Snares find by sector at December 2025



- Mining and armed hunting

Maps showing signs of mining and armed hunting:



B. BIODIVERSITY PROGRAM.

0. INTRODUCTION

The Biodiversity Program is one of several programs run by the FOSSEY FUND/DRC, focusing on certain aspects of biological diversity in the NCA and surrounding areas (AMISI, KASESE, and BONGOBOONGO). As the Grauer's gorilla is the flagship species of the FOSSEY FUND, the Biodiversity Program broadens its scope by conducting research not only on the gorilla itself, but also seeks to find answers to various questions related to the interaction between gorillas and other animals on the one hand, and between gorillas and their biotope on the other.

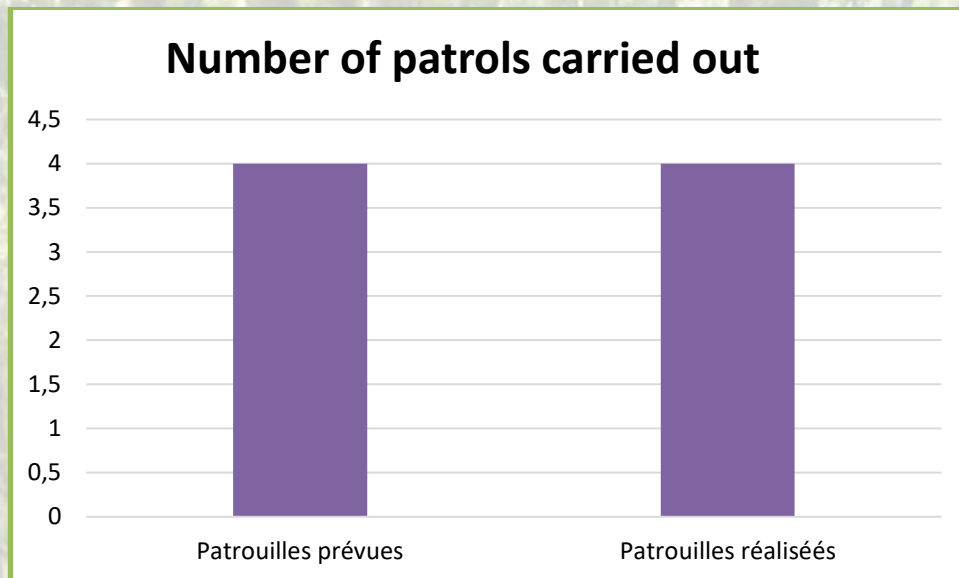
Gorilla conservation and forest restoration are intrinsically linked to the fight against climate change. Gorillas play a vital role in the regeneration of their habitat through their diet, while forests, as carbon sinks, store greenhouse gases and help regulate the climate.

Our teams were deployed in the field to quantify biomass, which involves measuring the total mass of organic matter in a specific ecosystem or area, usually over a standardized surface area. The indirect method was used to collect the data, which uses models based on field measurements such as tree diameter, canopy cover, and tree status on 146 plots divided into four (4) quadrants.

The objective of this plot sampling is to collect unbiased and statistically accurate biomass data (biometrics) on the project's substitution area. This data will be used to estimate the total amount of carbon remaining after the forest has been fully converted to its final state. It is then applied to the project's baseline to estimate baseline carbon dioxide equivalent (CO₂) emissions.

1. Patrol

Four patrols were carried out in December to quantify biomass.



2. Activity completed

- Quantification of biomass.

Activity date: December 1 to 14, 2025

Team leader:

1. MAKASA KYAMBIKWA Ghislain ;
2. KAPEPA MUBIRA Guillaume ;
3. NYONGO ISAYA
4. KINYALILE KAPEPA Aloise

Sectors:

Team 1 : OSOSO

Team 2 : OSOSO-BOLOWE

Team 3 : BIKULE- MAMBOBI

Team 4 : ATALALA

Objectives :

- Revisit permanent REDD+ plots for plant biomass quantification

Results :

Quadrant I

- ✓ Number of plots visited: 6 plots, including 222 individuals
- ✓ Status of trees on plots
 - Law (L) : 189 individuals
 - Sloped (LL) : 10 individuals
 - Death standing up (LD) : 14 individuals
 - Deaths on the ground (SD) : 9 individuals
- ✓ Different categories of trees
 - Large : 631 individuals
 - Medium : 576 individuals
 - Small : 3462 individuals

Quadrant II

- ✓ Number of plots visited: 8 plots, including 264 individuals
- ✓ Status of trees on plots
 - Large (L) : 222 individuals
 - Sloped (LL) : 23 individuals
 - Death standing up (LD) : 4 individuals
 - Deaths on the ground (SD) : 15 individuals
- ✓ Different categories of trees
 - Large : 621 individuals
 - Medium : 1590 individuals
 - Small : 3142 individuals

Quadrant III

- ✓ Number of plots visited: 14 plots, including 481 individuals
- ✓ Status of trees on plots
 - Large (L) : 308 individuals
 - Sloped (LL) : 120 individuals
 - Death standing up (LD): 14 individuals
 - Death on ground (SD) : 39 individuals
- ✓ Different categories of trees
 - Large : 1159 individuals
 - Medium : 1981 individuals

- Small : 13130 individuals

Quadrant IV

- ✓ Number of plots visited: 8 plots, including 262 individuals
- ✓ Status of trees on plots
 - Large (L) : 213 individuals
 - Sloped (LL) : 35 individuals
 - Death standing up : 8 individuals
 - Deaths on the ground (SD) : 6 individuals
- ✓ Different categories of trees
 - Large : 586 individuals
 - Medium : 1286 individuals
 - Small : 5678 individuals

Some observations made on canopy cover in relation to L status

Quadrant 1 :

- ✓ 9 individuals listed with the canopy end but without the canopy beginning relative to the center of the tree;
- ✓ 3 individuals listed with canopy start but no canopy end at the center of the tree ;
- ✓ 4 individuals listed without canopy start or end.

Quadrant 3 :

- ✓ 70 individuals listed with the canopy end but without the canopy beginning in relation to the center of the tree;
- ✓ 66 individuals listed with neither canopy start nor end.

C. COMMUNITY CONSERVATION PROGRAM.

COCO

Activities	Agroforestry	
	Priorities	Indicators
Supporting villages surrounding the NCA in the development of agroforestry	➤ Monitoring the distribution of agroforestry shrubs to the community. - initial monitoring of the distribution of agroforestry trees The crops that were distributed : - Avocado tree - Apple tree - Oxheart tree - Ma damer tree - Acacia trees Challenges encountered ✓ Lack of diverse seeds in the area	210 shrub seedlings distributed and monitored in the community, 42 households benefited from fruit trees that were monitored

Activities	Family Farming	
	Priorities	Indicators
Encouraging and supporting associations in setting up family farms	✓ Monitoring of certain speculations by certain beneficiaries: FAEVU, AMMD, Mama Maendeleo • Watermelon that is ready for harvest, • Sweet potato foliage stage harvested, • White eggplant in the harvesting phase and purple eggplant harvested. ✓ Monitoring sweet potatoes in the demonstration field at Nkuba and at the associations, ✓ Monitoring the cassava field to promote crop propagation within the community, ✓ Monitoring and harvesting 75 kg of cucumbers in the demonstration field, ✓ Planting of 300 pepper seedlings in the pilot field and 100 white eggplant seedlings, ✓ Visit to the AVEDEWA Association's soybean demonstration field in Biruwe.	Different harvests from associations: 500 kg of watermelons 7 kg of white eggplant 20 kg of new crop beans 40 kg of cabbage, including 10 kg of Biruwe and 30 kg of Mabeka. Seedling Distribution 500 pepper seedlings 300 tomato seedlings

Monitoring the harvest at the Nkuba base

Speculation	Quantity harvested	Consumption
Cucumbers	57 Kg	Base de Nkuba
Eggplant	50 Kg	Base de Nkuba
Watermelons	20 kg	Base Nkuba

This table shows the harvests at the Nkuba pilot field for the month of December 2025.

- ✓ Suivi et traitement par les produits phytosanitaire comme (fongicide dithane, insecticide dudu et fertiliser dans le champ pilote de Nkuba



Distribution of seedlings and harvesting of eggplants

500 cabbage seedlings

Dotation

1 sprayer in Obyanda

Nursery seedling

50 g white eggplant, 50 g bell peppers, 50 grams of purple eggplant in the test plot and, 50 kilograms of white eggplant, 50 grams of purple eggplant, and 10 grams of watermelon in Mabeka on a plot measuring 15 meters by 1 meter

Challenge :

A significant shortage of workers for a noble and fast-paced job.

Recommandation :

- Establish a team to monitor agricultural activities in various villages (agricultural extension workers)
- Conduct a study on the soil and climate conditions of the area.

Activity	Family-run livestock farming and animal domestication	
Priorities	Indicators	
1. Strengthening efforts to disseminate and improve fish farming practices in villages surrounding the NCA	2 ponds for rearing fry 2 ponds monitored in the Obianda community and 7 at the UTDPE complex in Nkuba	
✓ Monitoring, feeding the fish in the ponds, and catching male and female broodstock during the breeding season: Developing fry and larvae from the compost piles in the ponds, which are fed with green fodder and manure from goats, chickens, and rabbits;	1,500 fingerlings distributed to 6 households in these three villages	
✓ Monitoring of ponds belonging to associations that have received a new strain of Nile tilapia		

- ✓ Distribution of fingerlings in three villages, including Nkuba, Biruwe, and Obyanda
2. In the beekeeping sector, the following activities were carried out:
- ✓ Monitoring the condition of the hives
 - ✓ Weeding around the apiaries at the Nkuba base
 - ✓ Maintenance of the beehives at the Nkuba demonstration site
3. Encouraging and supporting households in establishing family-run agro-pastoral farms
- ✓ Monitoring and feeding of hens at the pilot farm,
 - ✓ Tour of the barns and chicken coops of the associations to which we distributed UTDPE breeding stock, Nkuba Breeders' Association,
 - ✓ Monitoring of goats at the Nkuba base,
 - ✓ Monitoring of broodstock from Nkuba and MABEKA.



Monitoring of beekeeping and fishing

Challenges encountered:

- The conditions for supplying broodstock are not met,
- Hausse de prix des géniteurs sur le marché.

There are 7 hives available, 3 of which contain bees
2 maintenance tasks

34 chickens, including 8 local breeds and 26 hybrid breeds
13 rabbits being monitored, including 8 does, 1 buck, and 4 young rabbits
2 goats: 1 female and 1 male
2 barns in the community visited

Distribution of broodstock to the community:
100 hybrid chickens, 10 rabbits, and 4 goats
Monitoring of association-owned barns
3 UTDPE goats and 2 goats for AEN.

Activity		Oil press		
Priorities				Indicators
Households	Production volumes	Quantities consumed	Quantités vendues	
11 househods	238liters	58 liters	180 liters	

The 180 liters sold at \$1 each total \$180; this money helps households meet their basic needs.

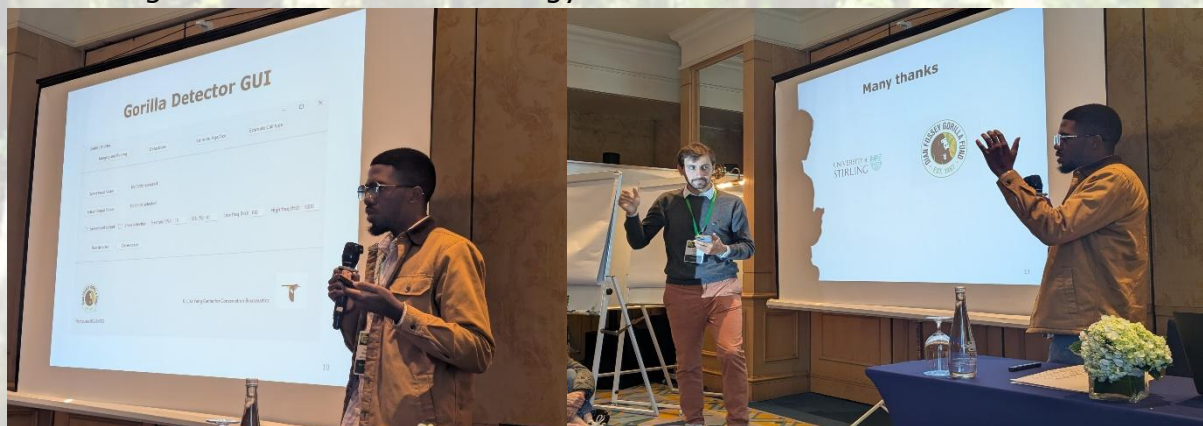
A. DATABASE PROGRAM.

Working on defining metrics for COCO programs and designing an interactive dashboard for COCO and REDD programs (consult the following link: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1qYK7zDMnhxPgkwXrUUAEQbs0OINB1FCo/view?usp=drive_link).

Tracking, monitoring, weather data entry

Monitoring data	4043
Tracking data	418
Weather station data	62633

Presenting in Conservation Technology Conference held in Vietnam



B. FINANCE PROGRAM

December 1–7

- Preparation of appendices accompanying the needs assessments
- Preparation of the funding request December 2025
- Preparation and payment of Fossey Fund suppliers

Upcoming Activities

- Receipt and distribution of funds December 2025 in Atlanta
- Payment of salaries in December 2025
- Payment of annual bonuses 2025
- QBO closing for the month of December 2025

December 8–12

- Data entry into QBO for December 2025
- Payments to various suppliers
- Compilation of weekly financial reports for Nkuba and Goma

Upcoming Activities

- Review of transmission diagrams and the Nkuba Base requirements statement,
- Preparation of the appendices accompanying the requirements statements,
- Preparation and payments to Fossey Fund suppliers.

Week of December 15–19

- Weekly reports on cash expenditures and physical inventory
- Tracking of Fossey Fund vehicle assets and reporting to Atlanta
- Compile scans of invoices for current and past month's expenses
- Payment of December salaries and 2025 bonuses
- MB and ACCESS bank reconciliation – December 2025
- Enter QBO journal entries for December 2025
- Verify and file invoices and other supporting documents
- Submit the December 2025 funding request to Fossey Fund Management.
- Upcoming Activities
- Follow up on the submission of the January 2026 request to Atlanta
- Payroll disbursement in January 2026
- 2025 Annual Report
- TMB and ACCESS bank reconciliation – December 2025
- Verification and filing of invoices and other supporting documents
- Submission of the January 2026 funding request to Fossey Fund Management.
- Compilation of monthly reports for the Goma and Nkuba funds

C. ADMINISTRATION AND HUMAN RESOURCES PROGRAM.

➤ Administration

1. Drafting and archiving administrative documents

➤ Responsibilities

- Draft correspondence to be sent to partners and third parties,
- Ensure that administrative documents are filed upon dispatch and receipt,
- Ensure the filing of contracts with partners and contractors.

➤ Achievements

- ✓ Lease agreement available
- ✓ Classification of administrative and miscellaneous documents

2. Management of office operating expenses

➤ Payment of various office bills

- ✓ Suppliers paid (Gopher Station: fuel for Goma office, Multi Medica Center: medical care for DFGF agents in Goma, Maison la Grace: fuel for Nkuba base, Eden Garden, Ets Espoir: all virtual transfers to suppliers and agents' salaries)

3. Management of meetings, training sessions, and other events.

- Weekly meeting with Inso
- Monthly meeting with the INGO Forum
- Joint meeting with OTUC unions
- Meeting with department heads
- Meeting with all staff members

- ✓ A weekly meeting with Inso,
- ✓ A monthly meeting with the INGO forum.

4. Mission management

Mission order for all FOSSEY FUND missionaries

- 4 assignment orders for each assignment, per diem payment if necessary.

5. Personnel management

- Personnel disponible à la NCA et dans les stations de vulgarisation
- Personal Leave
- Remboursement des soins médicaux des staffs
- Salaires reçus par Mpesa, Pepele Mobile, TMB, Cadeco et Access

- ✓ 170 staff members available, including 7 in Goma, 10 in Kasese, 10 in Bongobongo, 10 in Amisi, and the rest in Nkuba and Obaye,
- ✓ Salary, Mpesa, Pepele, TMB,
- ✓ 4 salary paid at the cash register,
- ✓ Health care vouchers for staff and their dependents in Goma and Nkuba.

Human resources	
➤ HR policy	
➤ Responsabilities	➤ Achievements
➤ Internal rules and regulations displayed and/or printed ➤ Unexcused absences ➤ Disciplinary measures ➤ Dismissal ➤ Resignation ➤ Death	✓ 1 ROI displayed or available in Kasese, BongoBongo, Amisi, and Nkuba ✓ Payment of IPR taxes for October 2025 ✓ Notification of unjustified absence sent to staff ✓ Update the annual leave file ✓ Drafting of one-month contracts for agents on fixed-term contracts in Nkuba for signature
➤ Forecast for the coming months: • Respond to the needs of the organization, • Follow-up on missing documents in the files on site in Nkuba, • Send scanned copies of leave request forms to the Goma administration, • The monthly absence report for agents at the Nkuba base.	

D. LOGISTICS PROGRAM

ACTIVITIES CARRIED OUT

1. PURCHASE

<i>Category</i>	<i>Equipment</i>	<i>Deposit</i>	<i>Units</i>	<i>Qty</i>
Office supplies	Liquid soap	Goma	Liters	10
	Close the gate	Goma	Liters	10
	Alkaline battery	Nkuba	Boxes	10
	Close the gate	Goma/ Nkuba	Liters	10
	Light bulbs	Goma/Nkuba	Parts	2
	Burundi soap	Nkuba	Dozens	2

	Spitter	Nkuba	Parts	1
Fourniture bureau	Carbon paper	/Nkuba	Parts	12
	Binder	Nkuba	Parts	15
Snack	Water	Goma	Boxes	10
	Milk	Goma	Box	1
	Coffee	Goma	Parts	2
	Sugar	Goma	Kg	10
Ration base vie Nkuba Kasese et Bongobongo	Cassava flour	Kasese/Nkuba	Measures	150
	Rice	Kasese/Nkuba	Measures	100
	Beans	Kasese/Nkuba	Measures	100
	Tomato	Kasese/Nkuba	Parts	150
	Smoked fish	Nkuba	Sachets	5
		Kasese	Kg	1
	Ember	Kasese/Nkuba	Bag	3
	Cowbell Milk	Kasese	Parts	15
	Meat	Nkuba	kg	35
	Plantain	Nkuba/Kasese	Diets	5

2. Report on the materials sent.

<i>Designation</i>	<i>Unit</i>	<i>Quantity</i>	<i>Location</i>
Tires	Parts	5	Nkuba
Solar panel	Parts	2	Nkuba
Battery	Parts	3	Nkuba
Spitter	Parts	1	Nkuba
Small ground mats	Parts	40	Nkuba
Tarps	Parts	50	Nkuba

Engine oil	Parts	115	Nkuba
Empty 5-liter container	Parts	30	Nkuba
Fogging disc	Piece	1	Nkuba

Vehicle Repair

Land Cruiser 008	Replacing the shock absorbers
Land Cruiser 006	Door Maintenance
Generator	Drain Cleaning Service

3. Consommations carburant

Heating oil	Liters	1395
Gasoline	Liters	

4. REPORT ON TRAVEL ARRANGEMENTS.

<i>Medium</i>	<i>Race Number</i>	<i>Departure location</i>	<i>Arrival location</i>
Vehicle	3	Nkuba	Walikale
Vehicle	6	Nkuba	Mubi
Vehicle	1	Goma	Kigali
Vehicle	5	Nkuba	Mabeka
Vehicle	7	Nkuba	Mubi
Vehicle	1	Nkuba	Amisi
Vehicle	2	Nkuba	Lubutu
Vehicle	2	Nkuba	Makana
Vehicle	4	Nkuba	Losu
Vehicle	13	Nkuba	Mubi
theft	9 officers	Walikale	Beni

5. Report on Patrol Ration Proceeds

Designation	Unity	Qty	Location
Tomato	Boxes	15	Nkuba/Kasese
Cookies	Boxes	34	Nkuba/ Kasese

Soft milk	Boxes	20	Nkuba/ Kasese
Cowbell Milk	Boxes	14	Nkuba/ Kasese
Sardines	Boxes	22	Nkuba/Kasese
Medisoft Soap	Parts	256	Nkuba/Kasese
Lighter	Parts	160	Nkuba/Kasese
Laundry soap	Bars	252	Nkuba/Kasese
Tea	Measures	42	Nkuba/Kasese
Salt	Bags	84	Nkuba/Kasese
Plantain	Diets	168	Nkuba/Kasese
Rina oil	Liters	252	Nkuba/Kasese
Smocked fish	Measures	252	Nkuba/Kasese
Poisson sale	Parts	420	Nkuba/Kasese
Beans	Measures	1008	Nkuba/Kasese
Onion	Measures	84	Nkuba/Kasese
Rice	Measures	3150	Nkuba/Kasese
Cassava flour	Measures	1260	Nkuba/Kasese
Corn flour	Measures	1260	Nkuba/Kasese
Condiment	Measures	42	Nkuba/Kasese
Rubber	Parts	420	Nkuba/Kasese
Meat	Kg	420	Nkuba/Kasese
Fry	Kg	42	Nkuba/Kasese

6. Report on the deployment of forest rangers:

- 3 deployments of ski patrols with their patrol rations

Construction:

Work by DFGF staff to maintain the road leading to the Nkuba base.

7. DIFFICULTY

Kisangani–Nkuba Road: Poor
Goma–Masisi–Walikale Road: Poor
Road to Nkuba Base: Fair
Road to Amisi Base: Fair
No flights from Kasese

Difficulty obtaining supplies to reach Nkuba and Kasese.

8. REPORT ON ACCOMMODATIONS AND MEALS.

<i>Overnight stay</i>	<i>Location</i>	<i>Number of people</i>
1	Beni	6
1	Walikale	2
1	Goma	1
1	Kigali	2

9. Report on the Purchase of Non-Manufactured Items for the Patrol Ration.

Designation	Unity	Quantity	Location
Plantain	Diets	120	Nkuba
Manioc flour	Measures	1050	Nkuba/Kasese
Corn flour	Measures	1050	Nkuba/Kasese
Salted fish		336	Nkuba/Kasese
Smocked fish	Measurette	210	Nkuba/Kasese
Beans	Measures	810	Nkuba/Kasese
Rice	Measures	2520	Nkuba/Kasese
Huile de palme	liters	84	Nkuba/Kasese
Meat	Kg	336	Nkuba/Kasese
Fry	kg	2	Kasese

10. DISTRIBUTION OF PATROL RATIONS

<i>Home</i>	<i>Number of patrol members</i>
Nkuba	40
Kasese	2

11. FUEL CONSUMPTION

<i>Marque</i>	<i>Dépôt</i>	<i>Unite</i>	<i>Quantite</i>
---------------	--------------	--------------	-----------------

Heating oil	Goma/Nkuba	Litres	2200
Gasoline	Nkuba/Goma	Litres	420

12. Payment of invoices.

- Electricity
- Garbage collection
- Internet
- Water
- Catering